

DIGITAL CLEANUP CHECKLIST

In an era where personal and professional activities are deeply integrated with digital systems, maintaining organized, secure, and efficient digital environments has become essential. A structured digital cleanup checklist provides a comprehensive framework for reviewing files, accounts, devices, cloud storage, subscriptions, and privacy settings to ensure optimal performance and data protection. By systematically addressing storage management, cybersecurity practices, data privacy, and ongoing maintenance, this checklist supports improved productivity, reduced digital clutter, minimized security risks, and stronger control over sensitive information.

1 File and Storage Cleanup

1.1 Declutter Devices

- ☐ Review and delete unnecessary files (downloads, duplicates, outdated documents).
- ☐ Empty recycle bin/trash permanently.
- ☐ Remove unused applications and software.
- ☐ Clear desktop clutter.

1.2 Organize Files

- ☐ Create a logical folder structure (Work / Personal / Finance / Legal / Media).
- ☐ Rename files consistently (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD format).
- ☐ Archive old projects to external storage or cloud archive.
- ☐ Compress large inactive folders.

1.3 Backup Strategy

- ☐ Perform a full backup (external drive + cloud backup).
- ☐ RVerify backup integrity (open sample files).
- ☐ Schedule automatic backups.

2 Account and Password Security

2.1 Audit Online Accounts

- ☐ List all active accounts (email, banking, subscriptions, social media).
- ☐ Close unused or duplicate accounts.
- ☐ Remove saved payment methods where not needed.

2.2 Strengthen Passwords

- ☐ Use a password manager.
- ☐ Replace weak/reused passwords.
- ☐ Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) on all critical accounts.
- ☐ Update recovery email and phone number.

2.3 Monitor Breaches

- ☐ Check for data breaches.
- ☐ Change passwords for compromised accounts immediately.

3 Email Cleanup

3.1 Inbox Zero Reset

- ☐ Archive or delete old emails.
- ☐ Create filters and rules for automation.
- ☐ Unsubscribe from newsletters and spam.
- ☐ Empty spam and trash folders.

3.2 Security Review

- ☐ Review login activity.
- ☐ Check connected third-party apps.
- ☐ Remove suspicious forwarding rules.

4 Mobile Device Hygiene

4.1 App Audit

- ☐ Delete unused apps.
- ☐ Review app permissions (camera, microphone, location).
- ☐ Clear app caches where necessary.

4.2 Storage and Media

- ☐ Remove duplicate photos/videos.
- ☐ Delete sensitive screenshots or documents.
- ☐ Backup photos to secure storage.

4.3 System Updates

- ☐ Update OS and apps.
- ☐ Restart device after updates.
- ☐ Enable automatic updates.

5 Computer and Browser Cleanup

5.1 Browser Hygiene

- ☐ Delete unused extensions.
- ☐ Review saved passwords.
- ☐ Clear cookies and cache.
- ☐ Remove suspicious plugins.

5.2 Security Scan

- ☐ Run antivirus and malware scans.
- ☐ Review startup programs.
- ☐ Enable firewall.

6 Cloud and Shared Storage

6.1 Cloud Audit

- ☐ Remove outdated shared links.
- ☐ Delete redundant backups.
- ☐ Review shared folder permissions.
- ☐ Organize folders logically.

6.2 Privacy Settings

- ☐ Review public vs private files.
- ☐ Disable public sharing unless necessary.

7 Financial and Subscription Review

7.1 Subscription Audit

- ☐ Review recurring charges.
- ☐ Update expired payment methods.
- ☐ Cancel unused subscriptions.

7.2 Financial Security

- ☐ Download and archive financial statements.
- ☐ Review credit report (if applicable).
- ☐ Enable transaction alerts.

8 Social Media and Online Presence

8.1 Profile Audit

- ☐ Update privacy settings.
- ☐ Review tagged photos.
- ☐ Remove outdated or sensitive posts.
- ☐ Remove unknown followers/connections.

8.2 Reputation Management

- ☐ Search your name online.
- ☐ Request removal of outdated public data where possible.